

# Design Rationale – Leadership Portfolio Redesign

## Project Overview

The objective of this redesign was to transform the PDGMS Leadership Portfolio from a monitoring dashboard into a narrative-driven career artifact. The existing portfolio structure was data-rich but felt similar to an analytics dashboard where every metric had equal visual weight. My goal was to create a portfolio that employees would feel proud to share with mentors, supervisors, and their future selves.

The redesigned experience follows a "pitch deck" mindset rather than a dashboard mindset. Instead of asking "What are my numbers?", the portfolio answers "What was my story this month?"

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## Design Goals

The redesign was guided by four primary goals:

1. Make the employee's monthly story understandable within the first few seconds.
  2. Prioritize narrative over metrics while still preserving complete data fidelity.
  3. Create clear information hierarchy so important signals stand out immediately.
  4. Preserve every backend data point without overwhelming the reader.
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## Key Design Decisions

### 1. Narrative-First Information Hierarchy

I intentionally placed narratives before detailed metrics in every section.

The assignment emphasized that the portfolio should feel like a career artifact rather than a dashboard. Therefore, each section begins with a narrative explaining what happened during the month, followed by supporting evidence and metrics.

This approach allows both employees and mentors to understand the significance of the work before examining individual numbers.

**Tradeoff:** Supervisors may prefer numbers first for faster review. However, because the portfolio's primary audience is the employee, I prioritized storytelling while still keeping metrics immediately visible below the narrative.

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## 2. Single Scrolling Page Instead of Multiple Tabs

I chose a single-page scrolling layout rather than a tab-based dashboard.

A pitch deck tells a coherent story in sequence:

- How did I perform?
- What did I deliver?
- How did I grow?
- What impact did I create?
- What challenges did I face?
- Where am I headed?

Using multiple tabs would fragment this narrative and create a dashboard-like experience. A single-page layout preserves continuity and makes the portfolio easier to share, export, and review during mentoring conversations.

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## 3. Prominent Identity and Career Signal

Employee identity was given strong visual prominence at the top of the page.

The portfolio begins with:

- Employee name
- Role
- Organization
- Portfolio month
- Permanent UID

This reinforces the idea that the portfolio belongs to the employee rather than the organization.

The hero section highlights a single dominant signal:

**"Strongest Month Since Joining"**

This provides immediate emotional and professional context before presenting detailed metrics.

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## **Position on Design Challenges**

### **Challenge 1 – The Signal**

I chose a combination of a narrative headline and supporting metrics.

The headline "Strongest Month Since Joining" communicates meaning instantly, while the accompanying metrics (Composite Score, Level, Pace, Projected Level) provide objective evidence.

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### **Challenge 2 – Story vs Data Ordering**

I adopted a narrative-first approach.

Narratives communicate significance, while metrics validate the narrative. This ordering better supports reflection, mentoring, and long-term career documentation.

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### **Challenge 3 – Six Sections**

I retained all six sections because each represents an important dimension of employee growth and contribution.

However, sections were visually prioritized:

High Priority:

- Executive Summary
- Contribution Highlights
- Capability Growth
- Career Journey

Secondary Priority:

- KPI Impact
  - Challenges Navigated
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## Challenge 4 – Constraint Section

I renamed the section from "Constraint Patterns" to "Challenges Navigated."

The original terminology risked making the portfolio feel like a complaint document. The revised framing emphasizes problem-solving, leadership, and learning rather than obstacles alone.

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## Challenge 5 – Portability and Identity

Because the portfolio follows employees throughout their careers, I ensured that organizational jargon was minimized and identity was emphasized.

Terms such as "IP Commits" and "Pending QA" were translated into more universally understandable language such as "Knowledge Contributions" and "Awaiting Review."

This improves readability for mentors or future employers unfamiliar with PDGMS.

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## Assumptions

Several assumptions were made during the redesign:

1. Employees are the primary audience for the portfolio.
  2. Narratives provided by the backend are trustworthy and should be surfaced prominently.
  3. The portfolio is primarily reviewed monthly rather than daily.
  4. The page may eventually be exported as a PDF or shared externally.
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## What I Would Do With More Time

If additional time were available, I would explore:

- PDF export optimized for mentoring conversations.
  - Alternative visualizations for career trajectory.
  - Adaptive layouts for supervisor and employee viewing modes.
  - Additional evidence sections using framework, process, ritual, and timesheet data.
  - User testing with employees and managers to validate information hierarchy decisions.
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## Conclusion

The redesign transforms the Leadership Portfolio from a collection of metrics into a personal career narrative supported by evidence. The final experience prioritizes storytelling, identity, and long-term career reflection while preserving complete fidelity to the underlying PDGMS data model.